

Ariel Cavalcante

Senior Product Designer | Fintech, Interaction Craft & Design Systems

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Profile

Senior Product Designer with 6+ years of experience designing complex financial, enterprise, web, and mobile products. Strong end-to-end ownership, from early exploration and product architecture through rapid prototyping, high-fidelity UI, interaction design, documentation, handoff, and production review. Experienced in turning complex fintech concepts into clear, intuitive, and accessible application experiences, with close Product-Engineering collaboration and a strong front-end foundation. Skilled in design systems, component libraries, design tokens, motion, AI-assisted workflows, and polished visual execution.

Core Skills

Product Design: End-to-End Ownership, Product Thinking, Product Architecture, UX Design, UI Design, User Flows, Responsive Web and Mobile Interfaces

Interaction and Visual Craft: High-Fidelity UI, Layout, Typography, Composition, Hierarchy, Motion, Microinteractions, Navigation, Interaction Details

Prototyping and Delivery: Rapid Prototyping, Functional Prototypes, Design Specifications, Documentation and Handoff, Design QA, Production Review

Design Systems: Component Libraries, Design Tokens, Semantic Tokens, Accessibility, Documentation, Governance, Light and Dark Themes

Collaboration: Product-Engineering Collaboration, Stakeholder Management, Design Advocacy, Technical Feasibility, Pairing and Design Critiques

AI and Development: AI-Powered Workflows, LLM-Assisted Analysis, Figma Make, Lovable, Codex, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, Styled-Components

Tools: Figma, FigJam, ProtoPie, Storybook, After Effects, Lottie, Hotjar, Matomo, Tableau, Power BI, Lighthouse, Chrome DevTools

Areas of Expertise

Product Design • Fintech • Payments • Credit • Complex Applications • Interaction Design • High-Fidelity UI • Design Systems • AI-Assisted Design • Mobile and Web • Accessibility • Front-end Collaboration

Professional Experience

Somapay

Nov 2024 – 2026

Senior Product Designer

Brazil

- Led end-to-end Product Design across financial and HRTech products, from early exploration and problem definition through flows, rapid prototypes, high-fidelity UI, documentation, handoff, and production review.
- Designed Crédito do Trabalhador from concept to launch, translating complex eligibility rules, financial regulations, contractual conditions, and business requirements into a clear and intuitive mobile lending experience.
- Redesigned critical credit, onboarding, Pix, payments, account, and support flows, using layout, navigation, hierarchy, interaction details, and clear system feedback to simplify complex financial tasks.
- Conducted focus groups, interviews, and usability testing to validate comprehension of interest rates, total cost of credit, eligibility, trust, transparency, and contractual conditions.
- Contributed to a 28% increase in the application's Google Play rating and supported its growth from approximately 200,000 to more than 750,000 users.
- Created and evolved a scalable Design System with component libraries, semantic design tokens, accessibility standards, documentation, governance, and support for light and dark themes.

- Designed the application’s dark mode by defining accessible contrast, semantic colour behaviour, interaction states, and scalable mappings across product surfaces.
- Built a Python review-scraping workflow and used LLM-assisted analysis to classify thousands of customer reviews, identify recurring friction, and support product prioritisation.
- Partnered closely with Product, Engineering, Infrastructure, Data, Marketing, Compliance, Support, and Commercial teams to define solutions, challenge assumptions, manage trade-offs, and maintain implementation quality.
- Created the internal Design Cell, facilitating design critiques, pairing, quality reviews, documentation, and knowledge sharing across the team.

Instituto Atlântico

Nov 2021 – Jul 2024

UX Designer

Brazil / United States

- Designed complex enterprise and data-rich web applications for Dell and other international technology clients, combining product architecture, UX, high-fidelity UI, and implementation support.
- Translated operational workflows, business rules, legacy-system constraints, and large volumes of information into clear navigation, responsive interfaces, dashboards, tables, and reusable interaction patterns.
- Created user flows, wireframes, interactive prototypes, polished interfaces, microinteractions, and implementation-ready documentation for engineering teams.
- Conducted interviews, usability testing, card sorting, workshops, benchmarking, accessibility assessments, and quantitative analysis using Matomo and Tableau.
- Performed accessibility assessments in code and usability for Dell products, evaluating semantic HTML, contrast, keyboard navigation, focus order, labels, error states, and interaction clarity with Lighthouse and Chrome DevTools.
- Collaborated closely with Product Managers, engineers, researchers, and stakeholders throughout discovery, refinement, handoff, implementation, and Design QA.
- Contributed to Design Systems, component libraries, accessibility standards, documentation, and visual consistency across multiple enterprise product surfaces.

Garimpo UX

Jan 2020 – Nov 2021

UX Designer

Brazil

- Designed web and mobile consumer products for retail and travel clients, combining research, product strategy, UX/UI Design, prototyping, and visual execution.
- Conducted interviews, usability testing, benchmarking, co-creation sessions, and qualitative and quantitative analysis to identify friction and validate solutions.
- Created user journeys, service maps, flows, wireframes, interactive prototypes, responsive high-fidelity interfaces, dashboards, and reusable components.
- Presented solutions directly to clients and stakeholders, balancing customer needs, business goals, technical feasibility, and delivery constraints.

Oowlish

Jun 2019 – Dec 2019

Front-end Designer

Brazil / United States

- Designed and implemented responsive application interfaces for Petco, connecting visual and interaction design directly to production code.
- Built reusable React components with Styled-Components and Storybook, supporting component libraries, Design Systems, and scalable product development.
- Collaborated with US-based designers and engineers to deliver accessible, pixel-accurate interfaces with clear handoff and strong implementation quality.
- Developed responsive HTML and CSS email templates and validated behaviour across browsers, devices, and email clients.

Additional Education

Coursework in Systems Analysis and Development — Programming logic, software architecture, data structures, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, and front-end development.

Coursework in Audiovisual and New Media — Visual communication, storytelling, animation, interaction design, motion design, and composition.

Languages

Portuguese: Native

English: Fluent / C2